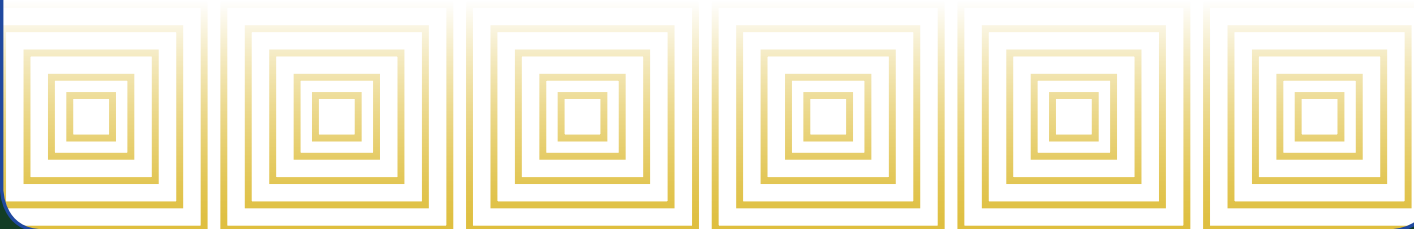


PSYCHOLOGY SYLLABUS FOR ARTS AND HUMANITIES PATHWAY

For Upper Secondary (S4-S6)

Kigali, 2026



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FOREWORD

The Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB) is honoured to present the second edition of the upper Secondary Level Psychology syllabus (S4–S6). It serves as an official guide for competence-based teaching and learning within the Arts and Humanities pathway, ensuring consistency in delivering quality education across the country. It supports the implementation of the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC) and reflects Rwanda's commitment to nurturing students' knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes.

Quality education is the foundation of Rwanda's sustainable development and prosperity. Aligned with the national education philosophy, this syllabus promotes critical thinking, creativity, inclusiveness, and holistic student development. It aims to empower young people with competences necessary to achieve full potential, equipping them with relevant knowledge, skills, the right attitudes and values to integrate effectively into society and pursue opportunities in a competitive world.

Anchored in Rwanda Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2), this syllabus supports the nation's goal of building a knowledge-based economy driven by innovation, resilience, and global competitiveness. It prioritizes student-centred pedagogy, active learning, and the practical application of knowledge to prepare student not only for academic success but also to become responsible, ethical, and productive citizens capable of contributing to Rwanda's continued transformation.

This syllabus reflects our determination to equip students with 21st-century skills, foster innovation, and instill values of integrity, social responsibility, and lifelong learning. Its success depends largely on the dedication and professionalism of teachers and school leaders. We therefore call upon all educators to embrace the approaches, methodologies, and assessment strategies outlined herein with commitment and passion, transforming classrooms into dynamic spaces of curiosity, creativity, and inspiration.

On behalf of REB, I extend my heartfelt appreciation to all who contributed to the development of this syllabus. Your expertise and dedication have been instrumental in shaping a curriculum that responds to the needs of our students. Together, we can ensure that education continues to be a powerful driver of our nation's development and prosperity.



Dr. MBARUSHIMANA Nelson

Director General, Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB)

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The development of this syllabus has been a collective effort that reflects the dedication, expertise, and commitment of many stakeholders. On behalf of the Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources Department of the Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB), I wish to express my deepest appreciation to all who contributed to the successful preparation of the Upper Secondary level Psychology syllabus for Arts and Humanities pathway (S4–S6).

Special thanks go to the subject experts, curriculum developers, teachers, and education partners whose insights, feedback, and professional contributions have been invaluable in shaping this syllabus. Your collaboration has ensured that the syllabus is not only aligned with Rwanda's Competence-Based Curriculum but also responsive to the aspirations of Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2).

We also acknowledge the invaluable support of development partners and education stakeholders who have consistently provided technical assistance in curriculum adaptation. Your partnership has greatly contributed to strengthening the quality of Rwanda's education system.

Finally, we call upon teachers, school leaders, and all education practitioners to use this syllabus with commitment and professionalism, ensuring that classrooms become vibrant learning environments that nurture knowledge, skills, values, and positive attitudes among students. Through your dedication, this syllabus will fulfil its purpose of empowering students to realize their full potential and contribute meaningfully to Rwanda's sustainable development.



MURUNGI Joan

Head of Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources Department

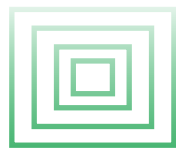
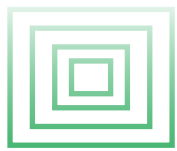
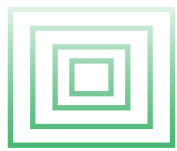
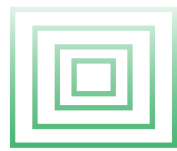
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General Introduction



1. General Introduction

1.1. Background to the syllabus adaptation

The adaptation of the Psychology syllabus for upper secondary level reflects Rwanda's ongoing commitment to strengthening the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC), first rolled out in 2015. Continuous feedback from teachers, school leaders, and education partners highlighted the need for improvements in content delivery, time allocation, and responsiveness to student needs.

This edition incorporates the Ministerial directive to harmonize school calendar to 33 weeks of learning per year, ensuring greater coherence, inclusiveness, and alignment with national priorities such as *Vision 2050* and the *National Strategy for Transformation (NST2)*, which emphasize a knowledge-based economy, responsible citizenship, and sustainable development.

Psychology at the upper secondary level aims to equip students with foundational knowledge, practical skills, and positive values needed to identify opportunities, solve real-life problems, and contribute meaningfully to their communities. The subject encourages students to think creatively, act ethically, and develop a sense of initiative, self-confidence, and social responsibility.

1.2. Teaching and learning Psychology

1.2.1. Rationale of teaching and learning Psychology

Psychology is central to understanding human behaviour, mental processes, and social interactions. Teaching Psychology helps students to develop self-awareness, empathy, and intrapersonal and interpersonal understanding. It enables them to apply psychological concepts to promote personal growth, mental health, and harmonious coexistence in families, schools, and communities.

Through Psychology, students acquire skills in observation, analysis, and evidence-based reasoning, preparing them for further studies and various professions, counselling, social work, and human resource management.

The subject fosters critical thinking, ethical decision-making, and resilience, the core competencies for holistic national development.

1.2.2. Psychology and society

Psychology enables students to understand how individuals and groups influence and are influenced by their social, cultural, and environmental contexts. Essentially, Psychology helps people in large part because it can explain why people act the way they do. With this kind of professional insight, a psychologist can help people improve their decision making, stress management and behavior based on understanding past behavior to better predict future behavior. All of this can help people have a more successful career, better relationships, more self-confidence and overall better communication. The subject of Psychology is paramount important in Rwanda given its history that climaxed in the 1994 Genocide against Tutsi impacting the people's mental health in general. This subject will produce more psychologists who will contribute to the development of the country and play a very vital role in raising awareness around mental health and an imminent need concerns the large gap between demand and supply in the domain of healing from psychological disorders.

1.2.3. Psychology and student

Psychology provides students with opportunities for self-exploration and growth, helping them develop self-awareness, resilience, and effective coping strategies. Psychology as a subject is a good choice for students who want to work with people and are interested in understanding human behavior and mental processes. Psychology gives students a sense of liberty to decide their own behavior. Awareness of one's attitude, values and personality are empowering as this will serve as a foundation to developing sense of self'. Helpful skills for Psychology majors include open-mindedness, critical thinking, problem solving and effective communication abilities. By learning how humans behave, students can apply some of the lessons to their own lives and potentially learn about themselves, too. Therefore, this subject helps people to handle stress, social dilemmas and high-pressure situations. This would also prompt students to take some precautionary measures to avoid harming themselves and/or others.

1.3. Competence

Competence is the ability to use an appropriate combination of knowledge, skills, attitudes, values and behavior to accomplish a particular task. That is the ability to apply learning with confidence in a range of situations. Basic competencies are addressed as broad subject competences and key competences embodied in the curriculum on year-on-year objectives and in clearly defined unit-specific learning competencies. Both generic competences and basic competences must be emphasized and consistently reflected in the teaching and learning process.

Competence in Psychology reflects students' ability to integrate knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values to understand and respond effectively to human behaviour and psychological phenomena. Teaching should emphasize critical analysis, empathy, ethical reasoning, and scientific inquiry. By acquiring these competences, students are better equipped to handle emotional challenges, maintain healthy relationships, and make informed, ethical decisions that contribute to personal and social well-being.

1.3.1. Generic competences

Generic competences are cross-cutting abilities developed across all subjects. They equip students with essential lifelong learning skills and underpin all other competences in the curriculum.

- Critical and problem-solving skills: Students develop the ability to think broadly and objectively, evaluate their causes and consequences, and suggest peaceful and practical solutions that contribute to harmony and sustainable living in their communities.
- Creativity and innovation: The acquisition of such skills will help students to take the initiative and use imagination beyond the knowledge provided, to generate new ideas and construct new concepts.
- Research: This will help students acquire the ability to gather, analyze, and interpret information from a variety of sources, including observations, interviews, and case studies to inform decisions and develop evidence-based conclusions.

- Communication in official languages: Teachers, irrespective of their subject, will ensure proper use of the language of instruction to help students communicate clearly, confidently, and respectfully in both spoken and written forms, enabling them to express ideas, negotiate, and present information effectively for logical and coherent exchange.
- Cooperation, interpersonal management and life skills: This competence enables students to work effectively with others, respect diverse opinions, and show empathy in group activities. It fosters moral values, responsibility, and active participation in community-oriented tasks such as environmental protection, health promotion, and service. Students also build social skills that enhance teamwork, leadership, and adaptability in addressing life's challenges.
- Lifelong learning: Students cultivate curiosity, initiative, and adaptability by linking classroom knowledge to real-life experiences. This empowers them with the ability to update knowledge and skills independently, cope with evolving societal needs, and pursue personal growth and continuous development.

1.3.2. Psychology broad competences

At the end of upper secondary education, students should be able to demonstrate the following broad competences specific to Psychology:

1. Apply psychological theories and thoughts to provide solutions mitigating human development problems.
2. Analyse the interactions of physiological and psychological functions on behavioural processes of human beings within the physical and social environment
3. Educate parents and the community on the fundamentals of providing a proper home to foster child growth and development.
4. Interpret different personality traits and how they influence behavior, thought, motivation, and emotion in a human being
5. Use theories and principles of learning to deal with behavioral changes

6. Act as a role model in inculcating positive attitudes and challenging negative motives among individuals
7. Apply social Psychology theories in the social context of development
8. Engage collaboratively in conflict resolution based on individuals' differences, intra and intergroup relationships and problems
9. Apply appropriate approaches to prevent the occurrence and worsening of psychosocial issues

1.3.3. Psychology and developing competences

The national policy documents basing on national aspirations identify some "*basic competencies*" alongside the "*generic competencies*" that will develop higher order thinking skills, and which will help subject learning and application of what has been learnt in real life situation through understanding, appreciation and presentation of information during the learning process, the student develops not only deductive and inductive skills but also communication, critical thinking and problem-solving skills in trying to make inferences and conclusions. Develop ability to discern and grasp attitudes, values feelings and ideas illustrated in scientific works not only analytically but also innovation, creativity and research. Group work and cooperative learning of Psychology promote interpersonal relations and teamwork. Learning Psychology prepares responsible citizens who are informed, sensitive, responsible citizen with the ability to critique and appreciate the methods used in the prevention and management of psychosocial issues and improvement of wellbeing at large.

2. Pedagogical approach

The pedagogical approach in Psychology under the CBC emphasizes student-centered, participatory, and inclusive methods that develop knowledge, skills, values, and competences for responsible citizenship. Teaching is interactive and active, engaging students through debates, discussions, role-plays, storytelling, field visits, projects, research, essay writing, case studies, reflective activities and personal growth. These approaches ensure that learning is enjoyable, personalized, and connected to real-life situations, while also fostering critical thinking, moral reasoning, and problem-solving.

2.1. Role of the teacher

The teaching and learning of Psychology at upper secondary school level must reflect the CBC principles, which promote student-centred, participatory, and practical methods. The main goal is to guide students acquire and apply Psychology knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes that prepare them to become innovative, responsible, and productive citizens.

Teachers should therefore move beyond traditional lecturing to interactive strategies that encourage inquiry, creativity, problem-solving, and collaboration. Learning must link theory with practice, making classroom experiences relevant to the student's environment and connect psychological concepts to daily life.

2.2. Role of the student

Students are active participants and co-creators of knowledge. They engage in inquiry, debates, problem-solving, and group collaboration while drawing connections between personal experiences, social realities, and religious teachings. Through these activities, students develop critical thinking, communication, respect for diversity, moral responsibility, and the ability to apply psychological insights to improve their well-being and relationships.

2.3. Inclusive and Special Needs Education (ISNE)

In line with Rwanda's inclusive education policy, all students regardless of ability have the right to access quality education. Teachers adapt teaching methods, materials, and assessment strategies to meet diverse needs, including those of students with disabilities. Differentiated instruction, assistive technologies, peer support, and individualized approaches are used to ensure equitable participation and achievement of learning outcomes. This inclusive approach recognizes students' varied paces, experiences, and abilities, creating an environment where every student can thrive.

3. Assessment approach

Assessment in the CBC is an essential part of the teaching and learning process, designed to evaluate students' progress in knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes while supporting continuous growth. It emphasizes real-life application and problem-solving, enabling students to demonstrate their competences in authentic contexts. Assessment involves systematically gathering and interpreting evidence to measure performance against established standards, providing constructive feedback to guide both teaching and learning.

Assessment should focus on students' ability to demonstrate creativity, innovation, problem-solving, ethical behaviour, and teamwork. It encourages reflection, continuous improvement, and the development of responsible entrepreneurial mindsets. It should therefore be comprehensive, covering both formative (continuous) and summative (end-of-term or national) evaluations. It should be transparent, fair, inclusive, and competence aligned.

3.1. Levels of assessment in Advanced Level across terms and national examinations

To provide a comprehensive picture of student achievement and development, assessment is conducted at multiple levels:

- (i) Diagnostic: Conducted before instruction to identify students' prior knowledge and skills; administered at the beginning of a unit or lesson to guide teaching.
- (ii) Formative / Continuous: Carried out during the learning process to track progress and provide feedback; implemented continuously through quizzes, projects, class activities, and teacher observations.
- (iii) Summative assessment:
 - End Term I: Administered after instruction to evaluate students' achievement of Term I content; conducted at the end of the first term as a school-based assessment.

- End Term II: District-coordinated assessment designed to measure achievement of Term II content; developed by schools and quality-checked at district level.
- End Term III: National assessment to evaluate mastery of the entire year's content; prepared, set, and moderated by NESA at the end of the third term.
- National Examinations: High-stakes assessments for certification, selection, and accountability; administered nationally at the end of key education cycles (P6, S3, S6) under NESA's authority. This examination integrates objective questions, structured responses, and applied tasks aligned with CBC principles to holistically measure student achievement.

In Advanced Level, all students will take 11 subjects in total: 7 core subjects and 4 compulsory subjects. Compulsory subjects include ICT, Entrepreneurship, General and Religious Studies, and Physical Education and Sport, which are mandatory for all students across all pathways.

All subjects will be assessed at the national level, except for Physical Education and Sport, General and Religious Studies, ICT, and Entrepreneurship, which will be assessed at the school level only.

Average scores from school, District, and comprehensive summative assessments will be weighted and included in the final national examination grading, initially contributing 10%, with the percentage gradually increasing as teachers gain experience and confidence in assessment practices.

3.2. Record keeping

Accurate record keeping is essential for monitoring student progress and informing instructional decisions. Teachers use tools such as portfolios, checklists, and report books to collect evidence of learning. Portfolios include samples of students' work, test results, projects, and self-reflections, serving as both a record of achievement and a diagnostic tool for guiding remedial action. These records provide data for feedback to students, teachers, and parents, and contribute to final evaluations.

3.3. Item writing in summative assessment

Summative assessment items must be valid, fair, reliable, and aligned with CBC principles. They should test a range of competencies, including knowledge recall, application, analysis, and values integration, while reflecting real-life contexts. Item writers follow a structured process that involves:

- Identify topic areas to be tested from the subject syllabus.
- Outline subject matter content to be considered as the basis for the test.
- Identify learning outcomes to be measured by the test.
- Preparing a test blueprint or table of specifications.
- Using verbs that require higher-order thinking beyond memorization.
- Applying transparent and consistent marking schemes.
- Greater weight is given to higher-order cognitive skills as stated in the syllabus.

3.4. Structure and format of national examinations

At the end of upper secondary education, students sit for a national examination that evaluates the psychological competences developed throughout the course. A single integrated paper is administered, covering the key components of the syllabus. The examination consists of diverse item types including objective questions, structured responses, and applied tasks designed to holistically assess students' mastery of subject content, analytical skills, and the broader CBC competences. An examination of three (3) hours will be set and will consist of three sections, "A", "B" and "C".

Section A

All questions in section “A” will be compulsory and will require clear and brief answers. This section will carry 40 marks. The questions will be set to give candidates the opportunity to read extensively and express informed, critical thinking, innovative and creative and relevant responses relating to the overall student’s level of knowledge, understanding and comprehension of the syllabus topics and objectives.

Section B

This section will be general in nature and require candidates to draw on their knowledge from across the syllabus while demonstrating an ability to explain, discuss, examine, apply, analyse, synthesize, evaluate, describe and show support for significant issues related to psychological activities. This section will carry 30 marks and students will answer a given number of questions as instructed. The ability to convey a sustained and well thought out argument will be credited.

Section C

This section will be specific in nature and require candidates to draw on their knowledge from across the syllabus while demonstrating an ability to design, invent, produce, devise, develop, propose, generate, reconstruct, plan, and apply significant issues related to psychological activities. This section will carry 30 marks and students will answer the number of questions given as instructed.

3.5. Reporting to parents

Regular communication with parents is an essential component of the CBC. This is achieved through progress reports, parent–teacher meetings, and school community activities. Since the CBC emphasizes a wide range of learning outcomes: knowledge, skills, attitudes, and competences, a single mark is insufficient to capture student progress. Effective reporting should highlight areas where students are excelling as well as those requiring improvement. Using descriptive feedback or simple rating scales (e.g., meeting expectations very well, meeting expectations, not meeting expectations) across knowledge, subject-specific skills, and competences provides a clearer and more comprehensive picture than numerical grades alone. This approach fosters meaningful parental involvement and supports students’ continued growth.

4. Resources

The effective implementation of this syllabus requires the provision and utilization of appropriate resources. These resources include both teaching and learning materials and qualified human personnel, without which the delivery of the syllabus would be ineffective. Teachers are encouraged to utilize both locally available and digital resources to create rich, relevant, and engaging learning experiences that promote creativity, problem-solving, and entrepreneurial thinking.

4.1. Materials needed for implementation of this syllabus

A variety of materials are essential to facilitate the effective teaching and learning of Psychology. These resources provide students with practical experiences, stimulate reflection, and foster the development of competences in understanding human behaviour, emotions, and mental processes. They include:

- Textbooks and reference materials: Updated Psychology textbooks, teacher's guides, student's books, dictionaries, and relevant reference materials that support both theoretical and practical learning. These should include examples and case studies contextualized to Rwanda's cultural and social realities.
- Teaching and learning aids: Visual and audio-visual resources such as charts, posters, infographics, models of the brain and sensory organs, diagrams, projectors, and educational videos. Digital tools such as e-books, online platforms, and multimedia applications should be used to illustrate key psychological concepts such as motivation, emotion, perception, and learning and to enhance students' understanding through interactive experiences.
- Library and resource centre materials: Access to a well-stocked library with Psychology journals, case studies, biographies of psychologists, and research reports. These materials encourage students to engage in further reading, independent research, and evidence-based inquiry.
- Psychology simulation and practical resources: Observation checklists, behavioural recording sheets, and simulation exercises such as mock counselling sessions, role plays, and group experiments. These enable students to apply psychological theories to real-life situations, enhancing problem-solving and communication skills.

- Field visit resources: Materials to support fieldwork and educational visits, such as observation journals, notebooks, questionnaires, and logistical support. Visits to counselling centres, ECD centres, hospitals, rehabilitation institutions, or schools provide students with experiential learning about mental health services and human behaviour in different settings.
- Community, cultural resources and memorial sites of genocide against Tutsi in 1994: Collaboration with local leaders, religious and cultural institutions, museums, memorial sites against Tutsi in 1994, and community groups to promote understanding of social values, resilience, trauma healing, and post-genocide against Tutsi mental health. These interactions help students relate psychological concepts to Rwanda's cultural and historical context.
- Assessment tools: Rubrics, checklists, student portfolios, self-assessment forms, and test materials that support continuous and summative assessment in line with the CBC. These tools help teachers evaluate students' progress in acquiring psychological knowledge, attitudes, and practical competences.

All materials and resources should be **inclusive and accessible**, ensuring that students with special educational needs can participate fully through adapted materials, assistive technologies, and flexible approaches.

4.2. Human resources

The successful implementation of this syllabus relies heavily on qualified, competent, and motivated human resources. The following are key personnel required for effective implementation:

- Teachers: Professional and well-trained Psychology teachers with both subject expertise and strong pedagogical skills in student-centred, participatory, and inclusive approaches. Teachers should model empathy, integrity, respect, and emotional stability, while facilitating discussions, projects, and activities that develop critical thinking, self-awareness, and interpersonal skills. They should also apply diverse assessment strategies to measure students' understanding, attitudes, and application of psychological concepts.

- Community resource persons: Mental health professionals, counsellors, social workers, psychologists, and educators who can share real-life experiences and insights. They may participate as guest speakers, mentors, or facilitators during school visits, workshops, and field activities, helping students connect psychological theories with real-life practice and community well-being.
- Parents and guardians: Partners in the educational process who provide emotional and moral support, monitor students' academic and behavioural progress, and collaborate with teachers to reinforce values such as empathy, responsibility, respect, and resilience at home. Their involvement helps strengthen students' emotional well-being and overall psychological development.
- Local authorities and partners: Support schools by linking them with mental health services, youth empowerment programs, and community-based initiatives that provide practical learning opportunities. They play a key role in promoting psychosocial well-being, awareness on mental health, and creating environments that foster personal growth and social responsibility among students.

Effective collaboration among stakeholders creates an enabling learning environment that equips students with Psychology knowledge, values, and practical competences needed for responsible citizenship, ethical behaviour, and meaningful contribution to national development.

4.3. Skills required for the teacher of Psychology

Effective implementation of this syllabus requires teachers with strong subject knowledge, pedagogical competence, and interpersonal skills. As facilitators and role models, teachers of Psychology guide students to develop critical thinking, empathy, ethical awareness, and an understanding of human behaviour that can be applied in real-life contexts. To achieve these goals, teachers should demonstrate the following key skills:

4.3.1. Subject matter expertise

- Strong mastery of Psychology concepts such as learning, motivation, perception, personality, development, emotion, and mental health.
- Ability to link psychological theories and principles with real-life examples and national priorities such as Rwanda's Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2).
- Skill in relating Psychology to other disciplines such as Biology, History, Languages, General and Religious Studies, to enhance interdisciplinary learning.
- Awareness of contemporary issues and trends in Psychology, including the use of technology in learning, mental health promotion, and social well-being.

4.3.2. Pedagogical and instructional skills

- Ability to design and implement student-centred, participatory, and inclusive teaching methods that encourage observation, experimentation, reflection, and critical analysis.
- Use of diverse teaching methods such as role plays, case studies, guided discovery, and fieldwork to make psychological concepts practical and engaging.
- Creativity and innovation in developing and applying diverse teaching resources, including ICT tools, realia, and community-based materials.
- Ability to adjust instruction to students' levels, ensuring inclusivity and engagement for all.
- Skill in managing classroom dynamics sensitively, respecting student diversity, and fostering a supportive and emotionally safe learning environment.

4.3.3. Assessment skills

- Proficiency in designing and using both formative and summative assessments aligned with CBC competencies.
- Effective use of rubrics, portfolios, checklists, reflection journals, and peer assessments to evaluate students' understanding and growth in psychological competences.
- Skill in developing valid, reliable, and fair assessment items that measure critical thinking, self-reflection, and application of psychological knowledge.
- Ability to analyze assessment outcomes to provide targeted support, guidance, and feedback for students' academic and emotional development.

4.3.4. Classroom management and facilitation

- Ability to establish a respectful, safe, and inclusive learning environment that promotes tolerance and values diversity.
- Proficiency in managing discussions on sensitive psychological topics with discretion, empathy, and professionalism.
- Competence in guiding cooperative learning, group investigations, and role plays that develop students' analytical and interpersonal skills.
- Consistent modelling of positive behaviour, emotional control, respect, and integrity as examples for students.

4.3.5. Communication and Interpersonal skills

- Excellent oral and written communication to clarify abstract psychological concepts, stimulate reflection, and facilitate discussion.
- Active listening, empathy, and sensitivity to students' emotional needs and personal differences.
- Collaboration with colleagues, parents, school leaders, and community professionals (e.g., counsellors, psychologists) to support students' holistic well-being.
- Ability to motivate and inspire students through encouragement and positive reinforcement.

4.3.6. Guidance and counselling skills

- Ability to provide psychological support, moral guidance, and emotional counselling to students, fostering confidence, resilience, and self-regulation.
- Demonstrating passion, patience, impartiality, and genuine care in dealing with students' individual differences and challenges.
- Supporting students in exploring career aspirations, personal development, and positive mental health practices.

4.3.7. Professional and ethical competence

- Upholding high ethical standards, integrity, impartiality in all teaching and assessment practices, and ethical conduct, serving as a role model for students.
- Capacity to balance academic instruction with the cultivation of values and responsible citizenship.
- Demonstrating commitment to continuous professional development (CPD) through reflective practice, practice, peer collaboration, and engagement with emerging research in Psychology.
- Promoting national values, peacebuilding, and responsible citizenship in alignment with Rwanda's education philosophy.

4.3.8. Research and innovation skills

- Engagement in action research and reflective practice to continuously improve teaching and learning of Psychology.
- Adaptation of innovative approaches and new technologies to enhance student participation.
- Encouraging students to apply psychological research methods in projects and community-based activities that promote well-being and problem-solving.
- Connecting global psychological insights to Rwanda's socio-cultural context to promote relevance and applied learning.

Teachers who possess these competences will not only deliver Psychology effectively but will also serve as mentors and role models, inspiring students to become empathetic, ethical, and responsible citizens who contribute positively to personal and national development.

5. Syllabus Units

5.1. Presentation of the structure of the syllabus

The Psychology syllabus is designed as a single, integrated syllabus implemented uniformly across all grades. Its structure follows a logical progression that ensures clarity, consistency, and alignment with the CBC approach. At each grade level, the syllabus is organized into *topic areas*, which are further broken down into *sub-topic areas*. Each sub-topic area is composed of *units*, and every unit is characterized by the following features:

1. **Alignment with lessons:** Each unit corresponds to a specified number of lessons, ensuring effective time allocation and instructional planning.
2. **Key Unit Competence:** Every unit is built around a *Key Unit Competence* that guides all teaching and learning activities. This competence represents the overall learning goal to be achieved by both teacher and students.

3. Learning objectives: Each key unit competence is translated into specific learning objectives, categorized as follows:

- **Type I (Knowledge and Understanding):** Focused on foundational knowledge and comprehension, often referred to as *Lower Order Thinking Skills (LOTS)*.
- **Type II and Type III (Skills, Attitudes, and Values):** Aimed at developing practical skills, critical thinking, ethical values, and positive attitudes. These objectives, known as *Higher Order Thinking Skills (HOTS)*, form the core focus of the adapted Competence-Based Curriculum.

4. Content Specification: Each unit outlines the scope of content to be taught and learned, ensuring that teachers and students work within the boundaries set by the stated learning objectives. Each unit suggests a non-exhaustive list of learning activities that are expected to engage, as much as possible, students in an interactive learning process (student-centered and participatory approaches). Finally, each unit is linked to other subjects, its assessment criteria, and the materials (or Resources) that are expected to be used in teaching and learning process.

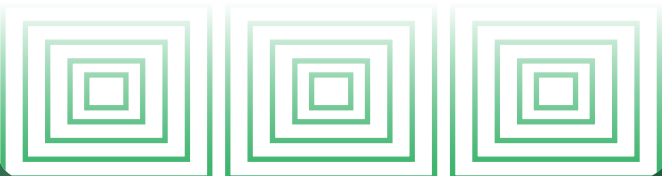
The present Psychology syllabus for Arts and Humanities Pathway has in total 7 main topic areas, 14 subtopic areas, 27 units and 693 periods. These units are distributed as follows:

Senior Four: 7 units with 231 periods

Senior Five: 9 units with 231 periods

Senior Six: 10 units with 231 periods

SENIOR FOUR



5.2. Psychology Syllabus of Senior Four for Arts and Humanities Pathway

General competences of the subject at the end of Senior Four:

At the end of Senior Four 4, each student should be able to:

- Analyse the nature and scope of Psychology
- Justify thoughts embedded in schools of Psychology
- Relate branches of Psychology to different working and living fields
- Apply knowledge of human development in real life contexts
- Apply principles and theories of human development in real life situations
- Assess human development by observing and analyzing physical, cognitive, language, and socio-emotional milestones.
- Examine the factors of human development.
- Apply knowledge and skills acquired throughout the year to analyse how environmental factors influence adolescent development and suggest practical solutions.

Subject: Psychology			Senior Four	Pathway: Arts and Humanities
Topic Area: General Psychology			Subtopic Area: Introduction to Psychology	
Unit 1: Nature and Scope of Psychology			No of Periods: 20	
Key unit competence: Analyse the nature and scope of Psychology				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes		
Define the key concepts and terms used in Psychology.	Use concepts of Psychology when describing human behavior.	Value the reason for understanding concepts of Psychology	Key concepts of Psychology: • Psychology, • Mental processes, • Mind, • Behavior, • Personality, • Emotion, • Intelligence, • Motivation, • Perception • Sensation,	• Students engage in guided discovery by observing real-life situations, images, or short scenarios to introduce and identify key psychological concepts, followed by class discussion and brief feedback. • Using group work, students construct and present concept maps on the meaning, nature, and key concepts of psychology using textbooks, library, and internet directly addressing the core concepts.
Explain the meaning, importance and nature of Psychology.	Formulate the meaning of Psychology one's own words	Appreciate future trends of Psychology and cultivate positive attitudes and values toward the study of this Psychology.		
Explain the evolution of Psychology.				

Illustrate the link between Psychology and other sciences.	Critically debate contemporary issues in Psychology using evidence-based reasoning. Prove the use of Psychology in our daily life. Describe the relationships between Psychology and other scientific disciplines, emphasizing how they inform and support each other.	Appreciate the relevance of Psychology in our everyday life.	• Memory, • Learning. History of Psychology: • Background and origins of Psychology, • Key figures in Psychology • Psychology as a science Importance of Psychology Relationship of Psychology and natural sciences Psychology and social sciences and humanities	• Through structured group discussions, students explore the importance and nature of psychology using case studies and real-life examples, helping them understand psychology as a discipline and its relevance in daily life. • Students apply problem-based learning by analyzing real-life scenarios to identify and explain psychological concepts such as emotion, perception, and motivation, and present their responses with feedback. • Using guided inquiry, students investigate the history and evolution of psychology and contributions of key figures using textbooks, library, and selected resources, and present findings in groups. • Through think-pair-share, students reflect on the characteristics that make psychology a science, discuss with peers, and share conclusions, linking to the concept of psychology as a scientific discipline.
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				• Students use cooperative learning with timelines and charts to explore the evolution of psychology, identify major developments, and relate them to contemporary perspectives. • Through individual reflection, students write short responses on the development and importance of psychology using various learning materials, reinforcing understanding of its relevance. • Using brainstorming and class discussion, students examine the roles and applications of psychology in everyday life and society, linking directly to its importance in different contexts. • Through pair and group discussions, students analyze the relationship between psychology and other sciences using diagrams and examples, helping them understand interdisciplinary connections.
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Link to other subjects: History, Literature in English, General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: Students can establish the relationship between Psychology and other sciences based on its nature and scope.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart, markers, flash cards, psychologist profiles, handouts describing concepts of Psychology, interactive mind maps, internet, projectors, PowerPoint presentations, Images and infographic to visualize concepts like the mind, behavior, etc.

Subject: Psychology			Senior Four	Pathway: Arts and Humanities
Topic Area: General Psychology			Subtopic Area: Schools and Branches of Psychology	
Unit 2: Schools of Psychology			Nº of Periods: 29	
Key unit competence: Justify thoughts embedded in schools of Psychology				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes		
Explain key ideas from schools of Psychology that shaped psychologists' understanding. Describe the main ideas and contributions of the major schools of Psychology	Compare and contrast schools of Psychology with clear, evidence-based reasoning. Create sustained, coherent arguments based on thoughts developed by different psychologists.	Appreciate different thoughts embedded in schools of Psychology. Exhibit confidence in judging thoughts embedded in the school of Psychology	Schools of Psychology: • Structuralism (Wundt) • Functionalism thoughts (William James) • Behaviorism (Watson, Pavlov) • Gestalt Psychology (Wertheimer, Kohler, Koffka)	Working in groups, students gather information on the different schools of Psychology from textbooks, library or online resources. They then summarize their findings and share them with the class in a plenary session. Students work in groups to construct and explain concept maps illustrating the meaning, nature, and key concepts of psychology, do class presentations to build a shared understanding.

Summarize different thoughts found in schools of Psychology.	Reflect on others' psychological works to identify those most beneficial to society.		• Psychoanalytic school (Sigmund Freud) • Humanism (Carl Rogers & Abraham Maslow) • Cognitivism (Jean Piaget)	Individually, students though library, online resources or watching videos about the schools of Psychology, reflect on the content, and share their observations with the class. In pairs, students discuss and critique ideas from different schools of Psychology. Two pairs then merge to review and refine each other's work, providing justified additions or revisions.
Link to other subjects: History, General and Religious studies, Entrepreneurship, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Students debate on different schools defending why their schools best explain human behavior.				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart and posters, markers, textbooks and handouts summarizing different schools of Psychology, PowerPoint presentations or slides show, short videos, internet, projectors, large screens, Quizzes and games (Kahoot, Multi meter, Quizizz, Plickers, or paper-based) for review and reinforcement, case study sheets for students, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four	Pathway: Arts and Humanities	
Topic Area: General Psychology			Subtopic Area: Schools and Branches of Psychology	
Unit 3: Branches of Psychology			No of Periods: 14	
Key unit competence: Relate branches of Psychology to different working and living fields				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes		
Identify the key psychologists associated with each major branch of Psychology.	Compare and contrast different branches of Psychology.	Develop a positive attitude toward understanding different branches of Psychology.	Branches of Psychology: • Developmental Psychology, • Cognitive Psychology, • Educational Psychology, • Social psychology • Health Psychology, • Forensic Psychology,	Individually, students research branches of Psychology, then share, discuss, and present their findings in groups during a plenary session.
Outline the historical development and evolution of the major branches of Psychology.	Describe how branches of Psychology contribute to the understanding of human behavior.	Adopt the inspiration of psychologists to different living fields in society. Appreciate the knowledge of the major branches of Psychology		Students work in small groups with flashcards showing the names and descriptions of different branches of Psychology. They match each branch to its description and provide real-life examples to illustrate them.

Explain the major branches and areas of specialization within Psychology. Describe the focus and key concepts of each major branch of Psychology.			• Family psychology • Child psychology • Experimental Psychology • Counseling Psychology • Clinical Psychology, Contribution of branches of Psychology to the understanding of human behavior	In pairs, students go through each branch of Psychology, discuss its importance and share ideas during plenary sessions. Individually, student conducts research to discover how branches of Psychology contribute to the understanding of human behavior and then present their findings. Students research an assigned branch of Psychology, present arguments in a group debate, respond to counterarguments, and reflect on each branch's relevance and applications.
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Link to other subjects: Biology, General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: Students can write an essay that relates Psychology to different fields/domains of work.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart and posters, markers, textbooks and handouts summarizing different branches of Psychology, PowerPoint presentations, short videos, charts, internet, projectors, interactive mind maps, large screens, Quizzes and games (Kahoot, Menti meter, Quizizz, Plickers, or paper-based) for review and reinforcement, case study sheets for student, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

Subject: Psychology			Senior Four	Pathway: Arts & Humanities
Topic Area: Human Development			Sub-Topic Area: Basics of Human Development	
Unit 4: Introduction to human development				Nº Periods: 24
Key unit competence: Apply knowledge of human development in real-life contexts				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes		
Define terms of developmental Psychology. Characterize human developmental domains. Explain basic functions of the brain and the link with motivation and emotions.	Compare and contrast meanings of developmental Psychology terms. Relate periods of development with those said in Rwandan culture.	Value the study of developmental Psychology in one's education. Appreciate the human development in different domains. Appreciate roles that the limbic and frontal regions of the brain play during emotion processing.	Key concepts of human development • Development, • Growth, • Stages of development, • Developmental milestones • Stimulus, • Reflex • Maturation, • Heredity, • Environment, • Sensitive period of development • Critical period of development	Students work in small groups to create a concept map of key terms and ideas in developmental Psychology. In pairs, students discuss and record the implications of developmental principles, then share their views in a plenary session. Individually, students match skills to corresponding developmental domains. Then after, students to present in plenary.

Identify the major stages of human development from infancy to old age. Describe the physical, cognitive, and socio-emotional changes that occur at each stage of development.	Summarize periods of development based on described behaviors at a given period. Describe systems that allow the brain to interact with the environment. Determine some of the social effects resulting from typical emotional processing	Develop respect and empathy for individuals at different stages of life. Value the diversity of human development and experiences	Principles of human development • Cephalo-caudal principle, • Proximo-distal principle, • Orthogenetic principle • Development is gradual and continuous • Development is sequential • The rate of development is not uniform • The development proceeds from general to specific • Principle of interaction (heredity and environment) Human developmental domains • Physical development and health, • Cognitive development,	In small groups, students explore assigned principles of human development, illustrate them with examples, and present. Then after, the class discusses each example, and students reflect on how the principles support human growth. Individually, student research about periods of development within Rwandan culture then in plenary, present their findings. Students in their groups conduct a discussion on how developmental domains are interrelated.
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			• Social-emotional development, • Language development. Stages of human development • Prenatal period, • Infancy • Toddlerhood, • Early Childhood, • Middle Childhood, • Adolescence, • Early Adulthood, • Middle Adulthood, • Late Adulthood. Brain basics • Parts of the brain and their functions: cerebellum, brain stem, cerebrum • Brain hemispheres • Brain lobes	Individually, students through library research, online resources or by watch a video on child development and classify observed skills by developmental domain, then compare their classifications with a partner. Individually, students watch a video about brain development (basic functions and role of the different sections of the brain) and draw a brain map with its architecture. Students, through the gallery work, observe different charts of brain structure, draw them, discuss their structure and present the findings.
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			Brain development Key messages for parents and caregivers on supporting children's brain development	
Link to other subjects: Biology, General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages, Physical Education and Sport				
Assessment criteria: Students visit the nearest ECD and make a report on physical, cognitive and social characteristics of students in that ECD.				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart and posters, markers, textbooks and handouts summarizing different stages of human development, PowerPoint presentations short videos, charts, internet, large screens, projectors, interactive mind maps, Quizzes and games (Kahoot, Menti meter, Quizizz, Plickers, or paper-based) for review and reinforcement, case study sheets for students, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four		Pathway: Arts and Humanities	
Topic Area: Human Development				Sub-Topic Area: Basics of Human Development	
Unit 5: Theories of human development					Nº of Periods: 39
Key unit competence: Apply the principles and theories of human development in real-life					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes			
Explain the concepts necessary to understand the theories of human growth and development. Describe theories of human development and their implications to lifelong situation.	Compare and contrast the key principles and approaches of different human development theories. Create real-life scenarios to illustrate and explain the major theories of human development.	Appreciate the principles and theories of human development in real-life situations. Respect the fact that human development theories have limitations and can be refined or challenged by research.	Key concepts of human development theories • Childhood • Assimilation • Accommodation • Egocentrism • Fixation • Object permanence • Unconsciousness	Before class, each student make a research at least three key concepts of human development and prepares brief notes. In class, they present their findings to the whole group for discussion and clarification. Individually, students reflect on human development, choose a theory, discuss it with a classmate, summarize how individuals change over time, and share their findings in a plenary session. Students work in groups to research an assigned human development theory,	

Describe the stages of development according to different theorists.	Apply knowledge about the human developmental theories to guide parenting, counseling, or social support across different life stages.	Demonstrate confidence in evaluating and comparing the strengths and limitations of different, sometimes conflicting, theories.	Theories of human development • Psychosexual (Sigmund Freud) • Psychosocial development theory (Erick Erikson) • Cognitive development theory (Jean Piaget), • Attachment theory (Bowlby) • Moral development theory (Laurence Kohlberg), • Language development theory (Gesell, Nativist, Behaviourist, Social interactionist) • Psychomotor development theory	display their findings on the classroom walls, and explain them to peers during a gallery walk. In groups, students make a chart to compare how different theorists conceive developmental periods. Orally, each student explains how the ideas of different theorists help interpret people's behaviors in real-life situations. In pairs, students research theorists they find most interesting and present their findings to the class.
Link to other subjects: Biology, General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Students create real-life scenarios and provide examples illustrating key human developmental theories across different life stages.				
Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks and handouts summarizing major theories (e.g., Piaget, Erikson, Vygotsky, Freud, Skinner), charts, posters, or infographics showing key theorists and their contributions, flashcards with theorists' names, stages, or principles for review activities, PowerPoint presentations or slideshows summarizing theories and stages, short videos or animations demonstrating developmental stages or real-life applications of theories, diagrams and visual timelines illustrating sequential stages of development in different theories, online quizzes or games (Kahoot, Quizizz, Menti meter, Plickers) to reinforce learning, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology	Senior Four		Pathway: Arts & Humanities	
Topic Area: Human Development			Sub-Topic Area: Milestones and Factors of Human Development	
Unit 6: Developmental milestones				Nº of Periods: 79
Key unit competence: Assess human development by observing and analyzing physical, cognitive, language, and socio-emotional milestones.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes		
Define key concepts related to human development. Explain developmental milestones from conception up to advanced age. Describe the major physical, cognitive, and socio-emotional changes at each stage of development.	Classify developmental milestones across the different periods of human development. Compare developmental progress across different stages of life to identify patterns or delays.	Appreciate the role of parents in supporting their child’s development. Value the importance of prenatal care to support development.	Key concepts related to developmental milestones (milestones, developmental domains, prenatal, conception, zygote, labor, delivery, etc.) Prenatal developmental milestones Labour and child birth Risk factor for women and infant during pregnancy and delivery	In groups, students participate in a “Development Concepts Challenge” where they match key developmental terms with definitions, examples, and real-life situations, then explain their answers during a class discussion. Students actively construct knowledge by simulating prenatal stages (zygote, embryo, fetus) through role-play or storyboards.

Identify the risk factors for women and infants during pregnancy and delivery. Explain factors that influence the attainment of developmental milestones. Illustrate typical behaviors or skills that reflect developmental progress in different stages.	Analyze case studies to determine whether a child or adult is meeting expected developmental milestones. Use knowledge of developmental milestones to suggest support strategies for individuals who are lagging. Create scenarios sequencing human developmental milestones from birth to advanced age.	Appreciate every stage of human development if has a positive and critical aspects.	Key message and recommended practices during the first 1000 days • Developmental milestones during infancy and toddlerhood (from birth to 3 years) • Key message and recommendation practices during infancy and toddlerhood period • Developmental milestones during early childhood (3-5/6 years) • Messages and recommendations practices during early childhood • Developmental milestones during middle and late childhood (6-12 years)	Each group explains developmental changes at their stage, and together they build a full developmental sequence, reinforcing understanding through experience and shared construction of knowledge. In groups, students analyze pictures and short case scenarios of infants and toddlers, identify observed developmental milestones, and classify them into physical, cognitive, language, and socio-emotional domains. Students role-play common behaviors of young children such as language use, play, emotional expression, and social interaction, while classmates identify the developmental milestones demonstrated.
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			• Key messages and recommendations formiddle and late childhood • Developmental milestones during adolescence (13-20/21 years) • Key messages and recommendation practices during adolescence • Developmental milestones during adulthood (21-50/65 years) • Developmental milestones during advanced age (65+)	In groups, students create a comparison chart showing developmental changes in physical growth, learning abilities, emotions, and peer relationships during middle and late childhood, then present findings to the class. Students participate in a debate on how adolescence influences emotions, behavior, relationships, and decision-making, using examples from real-life adolescent experiences. Students interview adults in their community about life responsibilities, career development, parenting, and social relationships, then prepare and present summarized reports.
Link to other subjects: Biology, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Students visit the nearest ECD and write a report on children’s developmental milestones focusing on physical, cognitive, language, and socio-emotional aspects, etc.				
Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks and handouts summarizing the major milestones, charts, posters, PowerPoint presentations and slideshows to explain milestones, short videos or animations demonstrating developmental stages, timeline diagrams, interactive digital tools and games such as Kahoot, Quizizz, Menti Meter, and Plickers can be used to assess and reinforce learning in an enjoyable way, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four		Pathway: Arts & Humanities	
Topic Area: Human Development				Sub-Topic Area: Milestones and Factors of Human Development	
Unit 7: Factors of human development					Nº of Periods: 26
Key unit competence: Examine the factors of human development					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes			
List the factors that influence human development Describe how human development is influenced by heredity and environment	Differentiate between hereditary and environmental influences through examples from real-life situations. Interpret case studies to identify the main factors affecting individual growth and development.	Value the role of a responsive community in supporting human development Appreciate the fact that development is influenced by a complex interaction of factors	Key terms related to factors of human development • Nature, • Nurture, • Heredity, • Genes, • Environment, • Interaction, • Chromosomal abnormalities, • Toxic stress	In groups, students participate in a “ <i>Human Development Vocabulary Challenge</i> ” where they match developmental terms with meanings, illustrations, and real-life examples, then explain their responses during a class discussion. Students participate in a “ <i>Family Traits Investigation</i> ” where they interview family members or observe pictures or family trait charts to identify inherited characteristics such as physical appearance (e.g., eye color, height, talents), then relate these to their own physical traits, abilities, and temperament.	

Explain how heredity and environmental work together to shape a human being	Apply knowledge of developmental factors to suggest ways to promote healthy growth at different life stages. Analyze how biological, psychological, and environmental factors interact to influence human development. Provide recommendations for actions that promote human development.	Respect human beings regardless of their differences	Biological factors of human development (nature/ heredity) • Function of genes and chromosomes in determining traits • Genetic abnormalities/ disorders	In pairs, they discuss their findings and explain how genes and chromosomes influence human traits and overall development. Students participate in a guided simulation demonstrating how genes and chromosomes determine traits, then analyze short case studies of individuals with genetic disorders to identify possible causes, developmental challenges, and ways society can provide support. Students analyze simplified case studies of individuals with genetic disorders. In groups, they identify causes, effects on development, and suggest supportive measures, strengthening analytical and application skills. Students participate in an <i>"Environmental Influences Mapping Activity"</i> where they collaboratively examine how family, peers, school, religion, media, culture,
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			Environmental factors of human development (nurture/ experiential) • Socializing agents, • Influence of physical /natural environment. • Impact of toxic stress Impact of drug abuse on human development	and the physical environment shape human development, then present real-life examples showing their influence on behavior and personality. Students examine how environmental conditions such as housing, nutrition, climate, sanitation, and access to education influence human growth and development, while illustrating influence webs that show how family, peers, school, and media interact to shape behaviour and development. They present and compare their findings in plenary. Students analyze case studies, images, or narrated scenarios related to toxic stress (e.g., neglect, conflict), examining its effects on emotional, cognitive, and social development. In groups, they discuss their findings and propose appropriate coping and support strategies.
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				Students examine real-life scenarios of substance abuse. They analyze its effects on physical, cognitive, and socio-emotional development, then propose prevention and intervention strategies. Students engage in a structured debate on "nature vs nurture," followed by case study analysis showing their interaction. They conclude by explaining how both factors jointly influence development.
Link to other subjects: Biology, General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: During the analysis of a scenario, student can explain how biological, psychological, and environmental factors interact to influence human development.				
Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks and handouts summarizing the major factors influencing human development, charts, posters, PowerPoint presentations and slideshows, short videos or animations, diagrams and visual timelines interactive digital tools and games such as Kahoot, Quizizz, Menti meter and Plickers, AI tools and other digital resources, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

SENIOR FIVE



5.3. Psychology Syllabus of Senior Five for Arts and Humanities Pathway

Key competences at the end of Senior Five

At the end of Senior Five, each student should be able to:

- Demonstrate an understanding of how behavior, emotion, motivation and thought patterns define an individual
- Judge the necessity of modern trends of personality in daily life
- Use knowledge acquired in theories of personality to explain individual differences
- Analyse personality typologies to understand individual behaviour
- Examine the history of learning Psychology
- Analyse different theories of learning and the way they influence current education system.
- Analyse the nature, characteristics and functioning of memory processes and systems
- Assess how intelligence impacts human behavior patterns
- Justify how motives of learning contribute to acquisition of behavior
- Apply knowledge and skills acquired throughout the year to analyse how the school environment influences learning and suggest practical solutions.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Five		Pathway: Arts & Humanities
Topic Area: Personality			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to Personality	
Unit 1: Nature of Personality				Nº of Periods: 16
Key unit competence: Demonstrate an understanding on how behavior, emotion, motivation, and thought patterns define an individual				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
- Define key concepts related to personality - Describe the main characteristics of personality - Describe individuals' behavior based on different thoughts in typologies.	- Use concepts of personality when reading, discussing and talking about personality. - Provide a justification of the role of biological and environmental factors in shaping personality	- Recognize individual differences by referring to the main characteristics and dimensions of personality. - Develop an acceptance of working, dealing and living with all people in harmony.	Concepts of personality - Personality - Personality development - Nature - Temperament - Character - Identity - Self- concept - Traits - Patterns, etc.	- Individually, students brainstorm the concepts to be discussed and write their findings on flashcards and then present. - In pairs, students discuss how personality typology helps people and then share ideas during plenary session. In groups, students discuss terminology related to typologies, and how they evolve according to different thinkers.

• Enumerate the basis that makes people different • Explain the meaning and importance of studying personality. • Explain how environment and family are factors to human personality development.	• Connect personality typologies to how individuals live and behave in real-life situations. • Use understanding of personality characteristics to manage or respond to individual differences effectively. • Apply key concepts of personality when reading, discussing, and communicating about personality-related topics.	• Appreciate that theories of typologies can be proven incorrect or correct by later research. • Accept individual differences in society. • - Explain and justify the influence of biological and environmental factors in shaping our personality.	Factors of personality • Nature (Biological factors) • Nurture (Environmental factors)	• In small groups, students create a chart comparing how different theorists define their typologies, then debate which typology they prefer and justify their choice. • Through think-pair-share, students reflect individually, discuss with a partner, and share with the class their ideas on what makes people different, • In groups, students use key concepts from the unit to share their views on personality traits and discuss factors that shape people's character.
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				• Using research work, student examine the relationship between typologies and real-life patterns of behavior. Then they present their findings in their respective panels or groups. • Students brainstorm factors of personality, read a handout about factors of personality and answer guiding questions.
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Link to other subjects: Biology, General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: Students can analyze relationships among key concepts (traits, patterns, and characteristics) using visual tools such as concept maps.

Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks or handouts describing concepts and examples of personality. Flip chart, markers, flash cards (showing a key term of personality and its definition), interactive mind maps, internet, projectors, PowerPoint presentations, images and infographics to visualize certain concepts, Concept maps or posters, video clips (short documentaries or animations explaining what makes people's personalities different.), student's handouts, reflection worksheet, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Five	Pathway: Arts & Humanities	
Topic Area: Personality			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to Personality	
Unit 2: Modern Trends of Personality				Nº of Periods: 14
Key unit competence: Explain modern trends in personality and their application in understanding individual differences				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
• Describe what is meant by modern approaches to personality in today's Psychology. • Identify major modern approaches used in the study of personality.	• Justify with relevant examples why modern trends of personality are emerging in Psychology. • Connect with researchers in finding more information and knowledge about human behaviors	• Recognize the importance of studying modern trends in understanding human behavior. • Value emerging trends in personality as important contributions to psychological practice.	Factors or dimensions of personalities • Sex differences • Warmth • Emotional stability • Dominance • Liveliness • Social boldness • Sensitivity • Openness to change	• Individually, students are asked to use internet or read books on new trends in Psychology (the activity is given before the sessions) then present their findings in plenary sessions. • One by one, students are asked to take their views on each trend talking about how individuals' personality is shaped by each of the modern trends.

• Enumerate the contribution of contemporary psychologists to modern personality research. • Explain the key modern trends in personality and their relevance to understanding human behavior. • Describe key features that distinguish modern trends from traditional personality theories.	• Summarize how modern trends influence the understanding of individual differences in real-life contexts.	• Express one's position and perspective on modern trends in personality, demonstrating openness, critical thinking, and respect for diverse viewpoints.	Aggression • Definition • Biological and emotional causes of aggression • The influence of social situations on aggression • Personal and cultural influences on aggression. Genetic aspects • Activity • Passivity • Fussiness • Cuddliness • Responsiveness	• Independently, students explore the concept of personality and then in pairs, discuss possible directions of modern trends • In small groups, students create concept maps, link modern trends to real-life examples, then present their maps to the class for discussion. • Students analyze a real or fictional individual's behavior using modern personality concepts in a case study activity.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: Students can explain a case study and report on modern personality trends and their application in understanding individual differences with real-life examples.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart and posters, markers, textbooks and handouts summarizing modern trends in personality, PowerPoint presentations or slides show, charts, internet, large screens, projectors, interactive mind maps, Quizzes and games (Kahoot, Menti meter, Quizizz, Plickers, or paper-based) for review and reinforcement, case study sheets for students, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

Subject: Psychology	Senior Five	Pathway: Arts & Humanities		
Topic Area: Personality		Sub-Topic Area: Personality Traits		
Unit 3: Theories of Personality				Nº of Periods: 21
Key unit competence: Use knowledge acquired in personality theory to explain individual differences				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
• Explain the main personality theories and their key concepts in Psychology. • Identify different thoughts on personality according to different schools of thoughts and views.	• Integrate multiple thoughts and theories about personality when defining and analyzing it in various situations. • Use thoughts and views embedded in theories of personality to understand human behavior	• Value different thoughts and views as cited in theories of personality. • Recognize and value the contributions of various theorists in the development of personality studies. • Respect individual differences in personality as highlighted by various theories.	Theories of personality: Psychoanalytic approach/theory, Neo-Freudian-psychoanalytic approach/theory Humanistic approach/theory, Cognitive approach/theory	• Individually, students read handouts or journals about different personality perspectives and related theories and discuss what they have read in different groups, • Students individually reflect on the application of personality theories, discuss their insights with a partner, and collaboratively develop a written explanation of how these theories can be used to describe different personalities.

• Describe the contributions of key theorists in the development of personality Psychology. • Outline the main differences and similarities among various personality theories.	• Analyse the similarities and differences between major personality theories and their approaches to explaining human behavior. • Create a visual diagram or concept map integrating key concepts from different personality theories to show their relationships. • Evaluate the relevance and practical application of a chosen personality theory in explaining individual behavior.			• Students work in small groups to compare two or more major personality theories. They create a comparison table listing the main concepts, assumptions, and approaches of each theory. • Students debate which of the theories of personality they find to be the most relevant to them and justify the position • In groups, students create a concept map that visually shows the relationships between different personality theories and how each explains human behavior. They may use color-coding, symbols, or other visual cues to highlight connections and similarities.
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				• Students are given a case study of an individual's behavior and asked to select a personality theory that best explains the behavior. They then write a short justification, evaluating the theory's strengths and limitations in that context, and share their reasoning in a guided class discussion.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: The students use knowledge acquired to explain the relationships, similarities, and differences among major personality theories, and apply the appropriate theories to explain real-life individual differences accurately.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart and posters, markers, textbooks and handouts, PowerPoint presentations or slides show, charts, internet, large screens, projectors, interactive mind maps, Quizzes and games (Kahoot, Menti meter, Quizizz, Plickers, or paper-based) for review and reinforcement, case study sheets for students, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

SUBJECT: PSYCHOLOGY		SENIOR 5		PATHWAY: ARTS & HUMANITIES	
TOPIC AREA: Personality			SUB-TOPIC AREA: Theories of Personality		
Unit 4: Personality Typologies					Nº of Periods: 30
Key unit competence: Analyze personality typologies to understand individual behavior					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
• Identify the main personality typologies and their key characteristics. • Illustrate the key concepts associated with typology. • Explain how different personality typologies influence individual differences.	• Compare and contrast theories of typologies. • Evaluate different views embedded in typologies. • Connect typologies to individuals' life style and behavior in real life. • Apply personality typologies to interpret individuals' behaviors in real-life situations	• Adopt the spirit of being aware of different views and thoughts behind typologies. • Have ethical respect and openness when considering various personality typologies and when interpreting human behavior in different contexts.	Concepts of ppersonality typologies Classification of personality by Heymans and Wiersma Traits approach, Extrovert and introvert Personality preferences of Myers-Briggs Characteristics of personality (openness, conscientiousness, Extraversion)	• Students are given a group assignment before the classroom session. The task requires them to read about personality typologies using textbooks or online resources. • In their respective groups, students define and identify typologies as read previously in their assignment and they present their findings.	

		• Accept one's own typology.	Accept one's own typology	• Students work in groups to analyze brief case studies of individuals and use personality typologies to interpret their behaviors. They then share their interpretations with the class, linking theory to real-life examples.
Link to other subjects: <i>History, General and Religious Studies, Biology, Psychology for Languages.</i>				
Assessment criteria: <i>Students write a report on a video illustrating, comparing various personality typologies</i>				
Teaching and learning materials: <i>Flip chart and posters, markers, video illustrating various personality typologies, textbooks and handouts, PowerPoint presentations or slides show, charts, internet, large screens, projectors, interactive mind maps, Quizzes and games (Kahoot, Mentimeter, Quizizz, Plickers, or paper-based) for review and reinforcement, case study sheets for students, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.</i>				

Subject: Psychology	Senior Five		Pathway: Arts & Humanities	
Topic Area: Learning Psychology			Sub-Topic Area: History and Types of Behavioral Learning	
Unit 5: History of Learning Psychology				Nº of Periods: 24
Key unit competence: Examine the history of learning Psychology				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
• Describe early thoughts to learn. • Enumerate psychologists' and learning theorists' contribution to learning • Explain the major schools of thought that shaped the study of learning.	• Refer to psychologists and learning theorists to explain how people acquire or change their behaviors. • Analyze the contribution of early thoughts to learning Psychology.	• Appreciate the contribution of early and modern psephologists in shaping our understanding of learning and human behaviour • Exhibit open-mindedness and critical reflection when examining the contributions of key psychologists and theorists to learning.	Understanding learning Philosophical roots of learning • Ideas of Plato (Allegory of Cave) • Socrates with Socratic dialogue • Aristotle (empiricism) • Rene Descartes (dualism and role of reason in learning) • John Locke's (Tabula Rasa) • Associationism (David Hume)	• Students individually research early learning approaches to learning using various sources, summarize their findings, and then collaborate in groups to discuss and organize key ideas, contributors, and perspectives on learning. • In groups, students research major learning theorists compare them to create a summary chart and present their findings to the class.

• Identify the key milestones in the historical development of learning Psychology. • Describe how modern neuroscience and technology are integrated to enhance understanding of learning processes.	• Apply historical insights from learning Psychology to explain current approaches to teaching and learning. • Assess the contributions of early approaches, psychologists, and learning theorists to the understanding of learning.	• Adopt a spirit of curiosity and respect for diverse perspectives in the study of learning Psychology, recognizing their relevance in education and everyday life.	• Emergency of Psychology as a scientific discipline (Wilhelm Wundt and introspection) Early approaches of learning: • Emotional and behavioural self-regulation • Cognitive self-regulation (executive functionalism) • Initiative, curiosity and creativity Psychologists and learning theories: • Socrates and Plato • Thorndike, John Watson, Ebbinghaus • Skinner and Jean Piaget Contribution of early psychologists: • Pavlov • Skinner	• In pairs, students organize learning theories chronologically, then merge with another pair to compare, discuss, and agree on the correct sequence. • In small groups, students watch a video on neuroscience tools and digital technologies in learning research, then create a chart linking each technology to specific learning processes.
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			• Thorndike • Watson • Ebbinghaus • Jean Piaget • Jerome Bruner • Vygotsky • Bandura Modern integration of neuroscience and technology in learning	
Link to other subjects: History, Literature in English, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Student develop a chronological table illustrating the evolution on learning Psychology.				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart and posters, markers, textbooks and handouts summarizing the content on history of learning Psychology, PowerPoint presentations or slides show, videos about milestones in learning Psychology, charts, internet, photograph and paintings, timelines and charts, role play scripts, large screens, projectors, interactive mind maps, Quizzes and games (Kahoot, Menti meter, Quizizz, Plickers, or paper-based) for review and reinforcement, case study sheets for students, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology	Senior Five	Pathway: Arts & Humanities		
Topic Area: Learning Psychology		Sub-Topic Area: History and Types of Behavioural Learning		
Unit 6: Theories of Learning				Nº of Periods: 54
Key unit competence: Analyze different theories of learning and the way they influence current education system				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
- Define key terms related to theories of learning. - Explain the key principles, processes, and theorists associated with each type of learning theory. - Differentiate different types of learning theories.	- Compare and contrast theories of learning. - Categorize the different types of learning theories based on their principles and processes.	- Appreciate that types of learning theories can be proven incorrect or limited by later research. - Appreciate the relevance of different types of learning theories in promoting effective teaching and learning.	Key concepts related to learning: Cognition, Stimulus, Response, Reinforcement, Punishment, Observation, Modeling, Socialization Behavioral learning (Behaviorism): - Description of Behaviorism - Classical conditioning - Introduction to classical conditioning (description, origin, importance) - Process of classical conditioning (Experiment of Pavlov)	- In groups, students explore and share key concepts of learning theories, then present their findings to the class. - Students individually study key theorists of learning, then reflect on them and summarize the significance of each contribution to the understanding of learning.

• State the implications of different types of learning in individual's daily life. • Discuss how various learning theories affect everyday life.	• Critique the different types of learning theories in terms of their strengths, limitations, and practical applications. • Create scenarios which reflect types of learning in teaching and learning process.	• Exhibit confidence in analyzing and judging differing theoretical perspectives.	• Key concepts in classical conditioning • Laws of conditioning (Law of association, Discrimination, Generalization, Extinction, Spontaneous recovery) • Applications of classical conditioning • Factors affecting classical conditioning (Frequency of pairing, Timing of stimulus presentation, Intensity of stimuli, Generalization and discrimination) • Operant Conditioning • Description and origin and foundation of Skinner theory (Work of E. L. Thorndike) • Key concepts of operant conditioning (Reinforcement, Punishment, Extinction) • The experiment of F. Skinner (Skinner Box) • Types of reinforcement and punishment	• Students work in pairs to create case studies applying theorists' ideas to everyday behavior, then join another pair to refine and present a single version to the class • Students do research to gather more information about the theorists they find most interesting and present findings to the whole class • Students explore key theorists on learning, memory, and behavior, watch illustrative videos, and write a brief case study linking the theorists' ideas to real-life behaviors.
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			• Schedules for reinforcement • Comparison and relationship with classical conditioning • Applications of operant conditioning (Education, Parenting, Workplace, Therapy) Social Learning theory/ Observational learning theory (Albert Bandura) • Introduction to Observational/Social Learning • Key concepts of observational learning (Modeling, Imitation, Vicarious Reinforcement) • Benefits of observational learning • Four Processes of Observational Learning (Bandura's Model) • Attention • Retention • Reproduction (Production) • Motivation • Types of models in social learning	• In small groups, students create a comparative chart showing how different theorists conceptualize learning.
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			• Some few real-world examples of observational learning • Positive and Negative impacts of observational learning theory • Factors influencing observational learning • Applications of observational learning (Education, Parenting, Media Influence, Therapy) Cognitive Learning Theory (Jean Piaget) • Description of cognitive theory • Major contributors in cognitive learning theory (Jean Piaget, Jerome Bruner) • Major concepts in cognitive learning theories (Schema, assimilation, accommodation, equilibration, discovery learning in cognitive theory) • Principles of cognitive learning	
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			• Four stages of cognitive development (Jean Piaget) • Benefits of cognitive learning. Insight Learning (Wolfgang Köhler, Max Wertheimer, Kurt Koffka) Constructivism (Jerome Bruner, J. Piaget) Social Constructivism (Vygotsky)	
Link to other subjects: History, General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Students create a comparative table showing types of learning theories and their chronological dates				
Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks and handouts, charts, posters, flashcards, PowerPoint presentations or slideshows, short videos or animations, diagrams and visual timelines, online quizzes or games (Kahoot, Quizizz, Menti meter, Plickers) to reinforce learning, chronological comparison table, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Five		Pathway: Arts & Humanities	
Topic Area: Learning Psychology				Sub-Topic Area: Memory and Intelligence	
Unit 7: Memory					Nº of Periods: 30
Key unit competence: Analyze nature, characteristics, and functioning of human memory processes and systems					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
• Identify the main components and functions of human memory systems. • Explain the nature, features, and processes of sensory, short-term, and long-term memory	• Use examples of everyday life to understand how memory works. • Apply findings from memory research to explain memory retention and forgetting. • Apply memory strategies to improve recall of information in real-life or academic tasks.	• Demonstrate a responsible and proactive attitude in supporting the proper functioning of memory. • Accept people with memory loss (forgetting).	Theories of memory • Information processing memory • Level of processing memory Types of Memory • Sensory memory • Short-term memory • Long-term memory • Implicit memory • Explicit memory	• In small groups, students analyze short case studies of individuals who forget or misremember information, identify the applicable forgetting theories, and discuss factors influencing memory accuracy. They illustrate the memory processes involved, propose strategies to improve recall, and present their findings to the class. • Using a Know-Want to know- Learned (KWL) chart, students individually record what they know and want to learn about memory types, receive teacher input, and then discuss what they have learned	

• Describe theories of forgetting and the factors that influence memory accuracy. • Illustrate memory processes and retrieval using examples from everyday life.	• Analyze real-life situations to identify the type of memory involved • Analyze scenarios to explain the information processing • Create a visual representation illustrating the processes of encoding, storage, retrieval, and forgetting.		Forgetting • The interference theory. • The decay theory of forgetting. • The retrieval failure Theory. • The cue-dependent theory of forgetting. • Repression/ motivation Strategies for enhancing memory	• Through think-pair-share technique, students suggest best practices to maintain remembrances. Then after they make further readings of these practices and present their findings in plenary • Students collaborate in groups to create visual representations of memory processes, review each other's work, and present their visuals while explaining how encoding, storage, retrieval, and forgetting to interact • In small groups, students identify common strategies for enhancing memory, discuss how each strategy can be applied in their learning, and give practical examples. They then select the most effective strategies, explain their importance, and present their findings to the class.
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Link to other subjects: Biology, Psychology for Languages, Mathematics.

Assessment criteria: Students develop a short project or presentation demonstrating how memory techniques can be applied to improve enhancing learning and problem-solving in academic and everyday life situations

Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks and handouts, charts, posters, flashcards, PowerPoint presentations or slideshows, short videos or animations, diagrams and visual timelines, online quizzes or games (Kahoot, Quizizz, Menti meter, Plickers) to reinforce learning, case studies, research summaries, puzzles. Web based simulation, projector, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Five		Pathway: Arts & Humanities	
Topic Area: Learning Psychology				Sub-Topic Area: Memory and Intelligence	
Unit 8: Intelligence					Nº of Periods: 21
Key unit competence: Assess how intelligence impacts human behaviours					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
• Outline intelligence types • Identify different theories and their key views on intelligence • Describe the concept of intelligence, including key definitions, primary theories, and main features	• Interpret findings from intelligence research to explain differences in problem-solving, reasoning, and learning among individuals. • Apply knowledge of intelligence learned to deal with learning challenges, problem-solving tasks, and individual differences in educational or everyday situations.	• Acknowledge and respect individual intelligence differences in all interactions. • Sympathize with people with low IQ and intellectual disabilities	Key terms related to intelligence • Definition of intelligence • Importance of studying intelligence in Psychology and everyday life. Brief history of intelligence Theories of intelligence • Sternberg's triarchic theory • Thurstone's theory • Gardner's theory of multiple intelligences • Emotional intelligence (Daniel Goleman)	• Students, in groups, share ideas about key concepts related to intelligence and present their views during plenary sessions. • Students individually research theories of intelligence and use a KWL chart to record prior knowledge, questions, and gaps in understanding. The teacher provides additional explanations and examples. Finally, students reflect on and share what they have learned about the theories.	

• Describe key research findings on intelligence and explain what they reveal about differences in human behavior and performance.	• Compare and contrast Sternberg's triarchic theory with Piaget's cognitive development stages to examine how various types of intelligence affect problem-solving and decision-making • Create a personal or group profile mapping the different types of intelligence.	• Piaget's theory of cognitive development Types of intelligence General intelligence (factor g) Multiple intelligence • Word Smart (linguistic intelligence) • Math Smart (numerical/ reasoning/logic intelligence) • Physically Smart (kinesthetic intelligence) • Music Smart (musical intelligence) • People Smart (interpersonal intelligence) • Self-Smart (intrapersonal intelligence) • Naturalistic intelligence • Existential intelligence • Visual-spatial intelligence • Fluid vs Crystallized	• Students use a KWL chart, students note what they already know, what they want to learn, and what they have learned about various types of intelligence, then present their findings to the class • Students analyse scenarios of people with different types of intelligence, then report on people's weaknesses and strengths.
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			Determinants of intelligence Measuring intelligence (Intelligence Quotient) • Application of IQ (Education placement, career guidance and vocational planning, understanding cognitive strengths and weaknesses) • Factors affecting intelligence Intellectual disability • Trisomy 21 • Autism • Down Syndrome • Fragile X Syndrome...	• In pairs, students read scenarios on intelligence development and calculate the IQ scores of the individuals described. • In small groups, students analyze scenarios of individuals with intellectual disabilities and develop strategies to support them. • Individually, students write a personal story explaining the factors that have influenced their intelligence since early childhood.
Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Biology, Psychology for Languages, Language Subjects, Mathematics, Physical Education and Sports.				
Assessment Criteria: Students write an essay in which they evaluate the impact of intelligence on personal, academic, and social contexts.				
Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks and handouts, charts, posters on multiple intelligence, or infographics, flashcards, PowerPoint presentations or slideshows, short videos or animations, diagrams and visual timelines, online quizzes or games (Kahoot, Quizizz, Menti meter, Plickers) to reinforce learning, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology	Senior Five	Pathway: Arts & Humanities		
Topic Area: Learning Psychology		Sub-Topic Area: Motives and Theories of Learning		
Unit 9: Motives of Learning				Nº of Periods: 21
Key unit competence: Justify how motives of learning contribute to acquisition of behavior				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
- Identify the key motives to learn. - Differentiate motives of learning based on their meanings. - Describe the different types of physiological, social, and personal motives, including their characteristics and examples.	- Explain how an individual's motives influence their behavior and attitudes - Investigate the reasons why people's behavior patterns and attitudes change in time and in space.	- Appreciate how physiological, social, and personal motives influence behavior and impact on personal and social decision-making. - Being inspired by the motives of learning to prevent the acquisition of deviant behaviors.	Physiological Motives - Hunger motive, - Thirsty motive, - Need for sleep, - Sex motive, - Maternal drive Social Motives - Achievement motive, - Aggressive motive, - Power motive,	- Students analyze everyday scenarios to identify and categorize the underlying motives as physiological, social, or personal, then reflect on patterns and how motives influence behavior. - In groups, students read, discuss and present in plenary about selected motives of learning.

• Explain how physiological, social, and personal motives influence human behavior in everyday life.	• Analyze real-life scenarios to identify physiological, social, and personal motives influencing human behavior. • Use knowledge of different motives to explain and predict individual actions in various everyday situations.		• Acquisitive motive, • Curiosity motive... Personal Motives • Force of habit, • Goals of life, • Levels of aspirations, • Attitudes and interests... Acquisition of new behaviour and attitude People's behaviour pattern and attitudes change in time and space	• Students enumerate motives of learning and describe each of them, then present their findings in their respective groups. • Individually, students select a behavior from a provided list and explain aloud which motive drives it and why, reflecting on how different motives influence behavior.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment Criteria: Students compose an essay describing the main learning motives and the ways people develop new behaviors

Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks and handouts, charts, posters, or infographics, flashcards, PowerPoint presentations or slideshows, short videos or animations, diagrams and visual timelines, online quizzes or games (Kahoot, Quizizz, Menti meter, Plickers) to reinforce learning, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

SENIOR SIX

5.4. Psychology Syllabus of Senior Six for Arts and Humanities Pathway

Key competences at the end of Senior Six

At the end of Senior Six, each student should be able to:

- Interpret the rationale of Social Psychology in relationships with others
- Judge different views of social psychologists about human behaviour formation and change
- Criticize group structure and models of social group formation
- Assess group phenomenon and their effect on people's behaviour
- Assess how individuals have control over their health and helping them make better choices of wellness
- Illustrate proper coping and management of emotions
- Determine the effects of psychological disorders on individuals' thoughts, feelings and actions
- Apply preventive measures to counter abnormal thoughts and behaviours
- Use effective listening to apply principles of guidance and counselling.
- Apply varied thoughts imbedded in guidance and counselling approaches.
- Apply knowledge and skills acquired throughout the year to analyse factors influencing positive psychosocial and mental health behaviours among adolescent students and suggest practical solutions.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Arts and Humanities	
Topic Area: Social Psychology				Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to Social Psychology	
Unit 1: Rationale of Social Psychology in Social Context					Nº of Periods: 10
Key unit competence: Interpret the rationale of Social Psychology in relationships with other disciplines					
Learning objectives				Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes			
• Define concepts of social Psychology. • Explain the nature and scope of Social Psychology. • Identify the features of social behavior and thoughts.	• Trace the key historical milestones in the development of Social Psychology • Illustrate how Social Psychology is related and differentiated from other disciplines such as sociology, Psychology social anthropology	• Recognize the importance of social Psychology in everyday life. • Commit to continuous learning and critical reflection in social Psychology.		Key concepts of Social Psychology • Social cognition • Self-concept • Social influence (conformity, compliance and obedience) • Prejudice and stereotypes • Discrimination	• In pairs, student reflect on key concepts of Social Psychology and present in plenary. • Students individually read handouts about nature and scope of social Psychology, make a summary in a report. • In plenary, students share ideas on what they have read and discuss how Social Psychology is related to or differentiated from other related disciplines such as sociology and anthropology.

• Describe the importance of social Psychology. • Describe the areas of studies of social Psychology.	• Interpret three levels of analysis in social Psychology with examples. • Analyse case studies that relate importance of social Psychology in everyday life.		Levels of analysis in social Psychology Nature and scope of Social Psychology Importance of social Psychology	• Through individual research and in their own words, students present the importance of Social Psychology in their own words. • In pairs, students analyze factors that contributed to the emergence of modern Social Psychology and discuss three levels of analysis with concrete examples. • In groups, students share ideas on three levels of analysis in social sciences and during plenary session identify level of analysis that would be related to social Psychology. • Individually, students write an essay in which they explain the importance of Social Psychology.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: Students can write an essay focusing on the interpretation of the rationale of Social Psychology.

Teaching and learning materials: Handouts on scope and nature of Social Psychology, videos, photos and printed case studies, internet, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

Subject: Psychology	Senior Six		Pathway: Arts and Humanities	
Topic Area: Social Psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to Social Psychology	
Unit 2: Key Theories of Social Psychology				Nº of Periods: 28
Key unit competence: Judge different views of social psychologists about human behavior formation and change				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes		
• Outline prominent theories in Social Psychology. • Describe key theories of Social Psychology. • Differentiate theories of Social Psychology.	• Evaluate views coined in different theories of Social Psychology. • Assess underlying reasons behind theories of Social Psychology. • Refer to Social Psychology views to understand why people behave in the way they behave. • Establish the link between views of Social Psychology to individual's behavior in social setting	• Demonstrate respect and open-mindedness when criticizing people's behavior in their social settings. • Value the contribution of Social Psychology theorists to the human being's real life.	Theories of Social Psychology • Attribution theory (Weiner) • Self-Determinant Theory (Eduard L. Deci and Richard M. Ryan) • Social facilitation theory (Allport) • Cognitive dissonance theory (Festinger) • Chock experiment (Milgram)	• Students are given an assignment in groups to read about the theories of Social Psychology in textbooks or internet and present the findings in plenary. Then they summarize best behavior to take from the presented findings.

			• Social Learning Theory (Albert Bandura) • Social identity theory (Tajfel)	• In groups, students assess the nature of each social theory and write a report. • The students read handouts of each theory into small group and present their views/ findings and then the teacher makes further guidance and facilitation.
Link to other subjects: History, General and Religious Studies , Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Students research major social psychologists summarize each one's explanation of how human behavior is formed and changed, then produce a written report.				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials, internet, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology	Senior Six		Pathway: Arts and Humanities	
Topic Area: Social Psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to Social Psychology	
Unit 3: Group Structure and Models of Social Group Formation				Nº of Periods: 28
Key unit competence: Criticize group structure and models of social group formation				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes		
• Spell out the types of groups and their structures. • Describe key theories of group formation and development in Social Psychology. • Explain how group development theories influence behaviors and attitudes.	• Compare and contrast the types of groups. • Organize group members and their roles in terms of group structure. • Apply psychological theories of group development in people’s behavior change.	• Accept group influence in shaping our behavior. • Appraise the conformity to group norms regarding types of groups and their structure. • Value the theories of social group formation in real life.	Types of groups • Primary groups • Secondary groups • Collectives • Categories • References groups, • Formal groups • Informal groups, etc.	• Each individual reads books, handouts, and e-resources about social groups development and presents the findings in plenary. • Students form groups and discuss every identified theory of group development in Social Psychology. Then they write the key points on flipchart and fix it on classroom wall. Through gallery walk, each group explains their findings.

			Models of social groups development • Tuckman's stages model • Kurt Lewin's individual change process • Fisher's theory of decision emergency group • Tubb's systems model	• Students work in small groups according to the identified "types of groups," in Social Psychology and they classify each group based on its structure. • In pairs, students link group development theories with group goals' attainment • Through inquiry-based learning, students identify how conflicts may arise within groups and ways of resolving them. • Through role play, students demonstrate how group development influences interpersonal relationships and practice strategies for preventing conflicts within groups.
Link to other subjects: History, General and Religious Studies, Entrepreneurship, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Individually, students write an essay in which they critique different models of social group formation.				
Teaching and learning materials: Textbook, books, Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials, internet, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Arts and Humanities	
Topic Area: Social Psychology				Sub-Topic Area: Group Dynamics	
Unit 4: Intragroup and intergroup dynamics					Nº of Periods: 18
Key unit competence: Assess group phenomenon and their effect on people’s behaviour					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes			
• Explain intra and intergroup dynamics and related boundaries • Demonstrate an understanding of group culture and relationship among group members • Explain the occurrence of group conflicts and mitigating mechanisms	• Investigate people’s reactions towards intra and intergroup dynamics. • Apply appropriate conflict resolution strategies to solve intra and intergroup conflicts.	• Investigate people’s reactions towards intra and intergroup dynamics. • Examine interactions within and between groups that help in identifying patterns of cooperation, conflict, and influence.	Introduction to group dynamics In-group and out-group dynamics Group boundaries Group values and culture Relationship between groups. Inter-group conflicts	• Students observe group interactions in videos, classroom simulations, or real-life examples, noting behaviors such as cooperation, conflict, and influence, and analyze these interactions by identifying recurring patterns and underlying causes. • Students relate their observations to theoretical concepts from books and handouts and discuss their findings in class, reflecting on how group structures and dynamics influence individual and collective behavior.	

		• Apply appropriate conflict resolution strategies to solve intra and intergroup conflicts.	Inter-group conflicts resolution strategies • Contact Hypothesis (intergroup conflict Theory: Allport) Subordinate identities and Interdependence	• Using KWL technique, individually, students list what they already know about group conflicts, including causes and any ways they have seen conflicts resolved. They then write questions about why conflicts occur and how they can be prevented or managed. After engaging with handouts, videos, and class discussions or role plays, students complete the "What I Learned" column by summarizing the causes of group conflicts, mechanisms for mitigating them, and real-life examples. Finally, they share their findings with the class and reflect on which strategies are most effective and why. • Students form groups and simulate conflicts between their groups, try to find solutions together and make presentations. (They may develop some materials illustrating conflicts and resolution mechanisms).
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: Students can create a sketch depicting the life of a particular group and how it influences the behavior of its members.

Teaching and learning materials: Textbooks, Books, Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials, internet, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six	Pathway: Arts and Humanities	
Topic Area: Psychopathology			Subtopic Area: Health Psychology	
Unit 5: Introduction to Health Psychology			No of Periods: 24	
Key unit competence: Assess how individuals have control over their health and make informed wellness choices				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning Activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
• Define health and health Psychology. • Explain the importance of learning health Psychology. • Explain history of health Psychology. • Outline factors that influence health Psychology. • Describe the role of genetics and environment on health Psychology.	• Justify the relevance of health Psychology in everyday life. • Exemplify models of health. • Compare and contrast factors that influence health Psychology.	• Internalize ways of illness management and minimizing illness. • Value individual differences that may affect health Psychology. • Be committed to staying up to date on one's health Psychology. • Make better choices of wellness.	• Understanding health and illness • Understanding Health Psychology • Brief history of health Psychology • Models of Health Psychology • Factors that influence health Psychology • Understanding illness in Health Psychology	• Individually, students make a list of their own characteristics when they feel healthy. • In small groups, students make a concept map of health and health Psychology. • Students read handouts on the models and factors of health Psychology and then discuss these factors in pairs.

				• Students use textbooks, handouts, and online resources to research how illness affects mental health, behavior, and coping strategies. In groups, they discuss and compare their findings, then share their conclusions in a plenary presentation, reflecting on the implications for health Psychology. • In pairs students make a timeline on key important dates in the history of health Psychology. • Students write an essay focusing on factors that influence health Psychology.
Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Physical Education and sport, Psychology for Languages, Biology.				
Assessment criteria: Students write an essay focusing on how health Psychology can help them improve bad behaviour that interferes with their daily life.				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials internet, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six	Pathway: Arts and Humanities	
Topic Area: Psychopathology			Subtopic Area: Health Psychology	
Unit 6: Emotions			No of Periods: 25	
Key unit competence: Illustrate proper coping and management of emotions				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning Activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
• Explain types of emotions and their effect on human behavior. • Describe theories of emotions. • Identify ways in which stress affects individuals.	• Compare contrast theories of emotions. • Analyze effects of stress on the body. • Develop tips which may help individuals cope with and manage stress.	• Appreciate the process to manage individuals' emotions. • Adopt a positive attitude toward managing emotions to enhance personal well-being. • Taking caution when dealing with issues regarding wellness.	• Meaning and Types of emotions • Theories of Emotions • Stress and its effect on health • Stress management • Direct and indirect coping mechanisms • Well-being	• Prior to the lesson, students read assigned materials on theories of emotion. In class, they engage in small group discussions to share insights and clarify their understanding. • Individually, students brainstorm their understanding on emotion and its effects on people's well-being. • After reading and discussing the notes on theories of emotions, students engage in a structured debate on the relevance and applicability of these theories in understanding real-life emotional experiences.

• Explain major emotional coping mechanisms and stress management strategies • Identify elements that lead to a sense of well-being.				Each group presents arguments supporting or questioning the usefulness of specific theories, followed by a class discussion to reflect different perspectives. • In small groups, students read case studies and analyze effects of stress on the body. • In small groups, students perform role plays that demonstrate effective ways of coping with stress in different real-life situations. • Students individually write an essay explaining the factors that contribute to sustained well-being.
Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Students can role play coping strategies to manage stress and emotions to improve their wellbeing.				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials, internet and online resources, Kahoot, Mentimeter, Quizizz, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology			Senior Six	Pathway: Arts and Humanities
Topic Area: Psychopathology			Subtopic Area: Psychological Disorders	
Unit 7: Introduction to Psychological Disorders			N° of Periods: 32	
Key unit competence: Determine the effects of psychological disorders on individuals’ thoughts, feelings and actions				
Learning objectives				
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
• Identify the perspectives of psychopathology in society. • Describe major psychological perspectives on abnormality and how each explains the development of abnormal behavior. • Describe different categories of psychosocial disorders.	• Classify different categories of psychological disorders. • Compare and contrast different categories of psychosocial disorders. • Assess the effect of abnormal behavior on people well-being.	• Adopt positive attitude when dealing with psychological disorders. • Display behaviors that reduce the occurrence of psychosocial abnormalities.	• Perspectives on abnormality (different trends) • Anxiety disorders • Somatoform disorders • Dissociative disorders • Personality disorders • Mood disorders • Schizophrenia • Psychosexual disorders • Psychosocial deviances	• Through an enquiry-based learning approach, students conduct library research by reading books and handouts on abnormality. They summarize their key findings and present them in groups to share insights and deepen understanding of the topic. • In plenary, students brainstorm about differences among psychological disorders.

• Explain key symptoms, causes, and distinguishing features of major disorders such as schizophrenia, psychosexual disorders, and psychosocial deviances.	• Apply appropriate Analyze possible causes and risk factors contributing to psychological disorders. • Psychological concepts to suggest coping or intervention strategies for individuals with psycho-social disorders.			• Students work in pairs and identify various psychosocial deviances they observe in daily life. • Students work in groups and identify symptoms and signs for selected psychosocial disorders. • Students work in groups and discover the biological and social factors influencing psychosocial disorders and make presentations.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, History, Physical Education and Sports, Biology, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: In essay writing, students can describe causes, signs and symptoms of psychological disorders and social deviances and their effects on individual's life.

Teaching and learning materials: Flash cards, flip chart, markers, books and handouts of psychopathology/abnormal Psychology, scripted case studies, audio-visual facilities, Written scenarios about certain psychological disorders, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

Subject: Psychology			Senior Six	Pathway: Arts and Humanities
Topic Area: Psychopathology			Subtopic Area: Psychological Disorders	
Unit 8: Prevention of Psychological Disorders			No of Periods: 15	
Key unit competence: Apply preventive measures to counter abnormal thoughts and behaviours				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning Activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
• Explain the risk factors influencing psychological disorders. • Identify the prevention strategies for psychological disorders.	• Take part in the prevention campaigns against the happening and worsening of community mental health issues. • Implement suitable preventive measures before and during the onset of psychological disorders • Engage at-risk populations in prevention programs	• Adopt lifestyles alleviating risk factors influencing psychosocial disorders. • Promote prevention approaches about psychosocial disorders.	Risk factors influencing Psychological disorders: • Anxiety, PTSD, • Somatoform disorder, • Dissociative disorders, • Mood disorders, • Schizophrenia disorders, • Personality disorders, • Disorders in childhood,	• Individually, students read books and handouts about possible prevention measures regarding psychological disorders and write a summary report. • Students visit local government and non-governmental organizations to inquire about public mental health issues and mitigating strategies. • Students brainstorm the risk factors affecting psychosocial problems

			• Psychosexual disorders, • Psychosocial deviances Prevention strategies for Psychological disorders (Primary, Secondary, Tertiary preventions)	• Students discuss in groups appropriate primary, secondary and tertiary prevention measures for specific situations and make presentations. • Students execute role plays to simulate psychological debriefing as prevention strategy for mental illnesses. • Students visit local government agencies to raise awareness on prevention strategies towards psychological disorders at individual, group/family and societal levels.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, History, Biology, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: Through a role-play of a prevention campaign, students demonstrate prevention and management strategies for individuals and groups at risk of psychosocial disorders.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart, markers, handouts, audio-visual materials, online resources, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

Subject: Psychology			Senior Six	Pathway: Arts and Humanities
Topic Area: Counseling Psychology			Subtopic Area: Guidance and Counselling	
Unit 9: Professional Guidance and Counseling			No of Periods: 21	
Key unit competence: Use effective listening to apply principles of guidance and counseling.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning Activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
• Define the concepts and types of guidance and counseling. • Demonstrate an understanding of the principles of guidance and counseling. • Explain the qualities of a good counselor.	• Apply principles of guidance and counseling in individual, group and family support. • Use various counseling techniques when interacting with clients suffering from psychological disorders. • Cope effectively with challenges encountered in guidance and counseling practice.	• Bear with counselor’s qualities in psychological workplace and in real life conditions. • Value the counseling techniques in every professional interaction with clients.	Key concepts in Guidance and counseling • Counseling, • Guidance, • Therapy, • Empathy, • Sympathy • Work alliance, • Trust, • Confidentiality, etc. Types of guidance • Educational, • Vocational, • Personal	• Individually, students read books, handouts about guidance and counselling and its importance and write a summary. • In pairs, students share ideas related to the concepts of guidance and counseling. • In groups, students classify and discuss the principles and types of guidance and counseling.

			Types of counseling • Directive Counseling, • Non-Directive Counseling, • Eclectic Counseling Principles of guidance of counseling • Autonomy, • Beneficence, • Non-maleficence, • Justice and fidelity, etc. Effective counseling techniques • Paraphrasing, • Spheres of influence, • Immediacy, • Core conditions, • Miracle questions, • Capping, etc.	• Through think-pair- share, students identify effective counseling techniques. • Students join groups, then identify and discuss critical factors that influence effective guidance and counseling. • Students work in groups on individual, group, and family case scenarios. They identify relevant counseling principles and perform short role-plays demonstrating their application, followed by a brief reflection on effectiveness. • Students pair up to role-play a client with a psychological disorder and a counselor. They practice at least two counseling techniques, switch roles, and receive peer and teacher feedback on their performance.
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			Phases/Steps of counselling Challenges in Guidance and Counselling Qualities of a good counselor • Patience, • Confidence, • Non-judgment, • Trust, • Respect, • Empathy, • Positive regard, etc.	• In small groups, students analyze common counseling challenges, brainstorm strategies, and create action plans. They present their solutions to the class and reflect individually on coping approaches.
Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.				
Assessment criteria: Through simulations, students can apply principles and techniques of guidance and counseling.				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, textbooks and handouts, audio-visual materials about counselling sessions, internet, online resources, scripts, professional codes of ethics for counsellor, journals and articles on current counseling issues, counseling record forms, interview sheets, and assessment tools, recorded role-plays, online counseling simulations or virtual role-plays, e-books, e-journals, and digital counseling manuals, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.				

Subject: Psychology			Senior Six	Pathway: Arts and Humanities
Topic Area: Counselling Psychology			Subtopic Area: Guidance and Counselling	
Unit 10: Counselling Theories and Approaches			No of Periods: 30	
Key unit competence: Apply varied thoughts imbedded in guidance and counseling approaches				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning Activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
• Describe effective counseling approaches at individual and group levels. • Demonstrate an understanding of advantages and disadvantages of counseling approaches. • Explain the major theories that form the foundation of counseling practice.	• Select appropriate counseling approaches at individual and group level depending on situation and severity of mental illness. • Apply the counseling approaches accurately towards people suffering from psychological disorders.	• Value the use of appropriate counseling approaches depending on the level and severity of mental illness. • Accept the clients’ status in relation to the problem presented.	Counseling approaches • Psychoanalysis • Client-centered • Behavioural • Cognitive • Humanistic • Systemic • Holistic/ integrative • Family system approaches therapy	• Individually, students read books and handouts, then share findings about the importance of every counseling approach identified. After, they join groups, classify and discuss the advantages and disadvantages of selected counseling approaches. • In plenary session, students observe audio-visual materials about the use of counseling approaches and share their observations to the class.

• Differentiate between various counseling approaches based on their key principles and applications.	• Effectively use various counseling techniques derived from different theoretical approaches in practical situations. • Integrate principles from major counseling theories when developing suitable intervention plans for clients with diverse psychological needs.			• Students familiarize themselves through role plays about the use of counseling approaches. • Students visit neuropsychiatric institutions to observe institutional settings; discuss and learn from practitioners about the use of effective counseling approaches.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Languages.

Assessment criteria: Students role-play counseling session scenarios and apply concepts from counseling theories to manage psychosocial issues.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts, online resources, audio-visual materials, internet, observation checklists, AI tools and other digital resources, etc.

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ANNEX

Subjects and Weekly Time Allocation for Upper Secondary Arts and Humanities Pathway (S4-S6)

Subject	Number of periods		
I. Major Core Subjects: Examinable at National Level	(Period= 40 minutes)		
	S4	S5	S6
1. History	7	7	7
2. Literature in English	7	7	7
3. Geography	7	7	7
4. Psychology	7	7	7
II. Minor Core Subjects: Examinable at National Level			
5. French	3	3	3
6. Kinyarwanda	3	3	3
7. Basic Mathematics	3	3	3
Sub-total 1	37	37	37
III. General Subjects: Examinable at School level			
8. ICT	3	3	3
9. Entrepreneurship	3	3	3
10. General and Religious Studies	3	3	3
11. Physical Education and Sports	2	2	2

Sub-total 2	11	11	11
III. Co-curricular activities (compulsory)	2	2	2
Total number of contact periods per week	50	50	50
Total number of contact hours/week	33.3	33.3	33.3
Total number of contact hours per year (39 weeks)	1300	1300	1300